

Company Policy and Customer Service Knowledge Base

Customer Support Knowledge Base

1. Customer Service Standards

Contoso Devices aims to provide clear, respectful, and useful customer support. Support interactions should focus on understanding the customer's issue, identifying applicable policy, and providing practical next steps.

Customers are encouraged to provide accurate descriptions of their problem and relevant order or product information. Support representatives should avoid requesting information that is unnecessary for resolving the issue.

2. Support Hours

Customer support is available Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM IST. Limited support is available on weekends through email.

Customer question: When can I speak with customer support? **Answer:** Standard customer support hours are Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM–6:00 PM IST. Weekend assistance is limited to email support.

3. Communication Standards

Support communication should be professional, concise, and understandable. Customers should receive an explanation of the applicable process rather than unexplained decisions whenever practical.

Customers should provide complete information about the problem while avoiding passwords, authentication codes, payment credentials, or other secrets.

4. Privacy and Customer Information

Customer information should be handled carefully and only used for legitimate support purposes. Customers should not be asked to disclose passwords or one-time security codes.

Customer question: Should I send my password to support so they can log in? **Answer:** No. Passwords and authentication codes should never be shared with support personnel.

5. Account Security

Customers are responsible for protecting account credentials and should use unique passwords, secure devices, and appropriate authentication controls. Unexpected security messages should be treated cautiously.

If unauthorized access is suspected, the customer should secure the account through official recovery procedures and contact support.

6. Acceptable Use and Customer Responsibilities

Customers should use support channels for legitimate product, account, order, shipping, return, refund, warranty, and troubleshooting needs. Abusive or threatening communication can interfere with support operations.

Customers are responsible for providing accurate information and following reasonable safety and product-use instructions.

7. Service Limitations

Support can explain documented product policies and troubleshooting procedures but cannot guarantee outcomes that depend on inspection, shipping carriers, payment providers, or other external processes.

Policy-based decisions may require verification or product inspection before a final determination is made.

8. Complaints and Escalation

Customers who believe an issue was not resolved can request escalation. A useful escalation request includes the issue, previous steps attempted, relevant order or product information, and the outcome the customer is seeking.

Escalation does not automatically change eligibility rules. It ensures that the case is reviewed through the appropriate support process.

9. Policy Exceptions

Exceptions should not be assumed. If a customer believes special circumstances apply, the customer should explain the circumstances and request a review.

Customer question: Can support always make an exception to the return period? **Answer:** No automatic exception should be assumed. The customer should request a review and provide the relevant circumstances.

10. Service Interruptions

During outages or service interruptions, support may have limited ability to access account or order information. Customers should follow official service instructions and retry when the service becomes available.

Customer Service Scenarios

Scenario: A customer is upset about a delayed shipment. Support should acknowledge the issue, review the tracking information, explain the available process, and provide the next appropriate step.

Scenario: A customer requests an exception without providing circumstances. Support should ask for relevant details and explain that exceptions are not automatic.

Scenario: A customer sends a password in a support message. The customer should be advised not to share credentials and to secure the account if necessary.

Policy FAQ

Are support hours every day? No. Standard hours are Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM–6:00 PM IST, with limited weekend email support.

Can escalation guarantee a different decision? No. Escalation provides additional review but does not automatically override policy.

Can customers request privacy-related assistance? Yes, customers can raise questions through the appropriate support process.

Should customers provide all account credentials during support? No. Passwords and authentication codes should not be shared.

Detailed Customer Scenarios and Decision Examples

The following examples illustrate how the knowledge base should be applied to different customer wording. The examples intentionally use varied language so retrieval systems can connect related requests to the correct policy.

Support-hours example

A customer contacts support on a weekday at 2 PM IST. This falls within the standard Monday–Friday, 9 AM–6 PM IST support window.

Recommended support approach: identify the customer's intent, locate the applicable documented rule, state only what the knowledge base supports, and provide the next appropriate action. If eligibility cannot be established from the available information, request the relevant details or direct the customer to support review rather than inventing an exception.

Weekend example

A customer needs help on a Sunday. Weekend assistance is limited to email, so the customer should use the available email channel.

Recommended support approach: identify the customer's intent, locate the applicable documented rule, state only what the knowledge base supports, and provide the next appropriate action. If eligibility cannot be established from the available information, request the relevant details or direct the customer to support review rather than inventing an exception.

Privacy example

A customer offers their password to speed up troubleshooting. Support should not request or accept the password.

Recommended support approach: identify the customer's intent, locate the applicable documented rule, state only what the knowledge base supports, and provide the next appropriate action. If eligibility cannot be established from the available information, request the relevant details or direct the customer to support review rather than inventing an exception.

Escalation example

A customer disagrees with an initial decision. They can request escalation with the issue, previous steps, and desired resolution.

Recommended support approach: identify the customer's intent, locate the applicable documented rule, state only what the knowledge base supports, and provide the next appropriate action. If eligibility cannot be established from the available information, request the relevant details or direct the customer to support review rather than inventing an exception.

Exception example

A customer asks for a policy exception without explaining the circumstances. Support should request relevant details rather than promise an exception.

Recommended support approach: identify the customer's intent, locate the applicable documented rule, state only what the knowledge base supports, and provide the next appropriate action. If eligibility cannot be established from the available information, request the relevant details or direct the customer to support review rather than inventing an exception.

Communication example

A customer reports a service interruption. Support should explain known limitations and provide the documented next step instead of inventing an estimated recovery time.

Recommended support approach: identify the customer's intent, locate the applicable documented rule, state only what the knowledge base supports, and provide the next appropriate action. If eligibility cannot be established from the available information, request the relevant details or direct the customer to support review rather than inventing an exception.

Knowledge Retrieval Reference

Customer questions may use different terms from the policy. For example, a customer may say that an item is broken, faulty, damaged, defective, or not working. The support process should distinguish the underlying condition rather than relying on a single keyword.

A return question should be evaluated against the return period, product condition, reason for return, and applicable exclusions. A warranty question should be evaluated against warranty duration, covered conditions, and exclusions.

A shipping question should be evaluated against order processing, carrier tracking, delivery status, address information, and shipment condition. A troubleshooting question should be evaluated against the specific symptom and the documented diagnostic procedure.

When the knowledge base does not contain sufficient information to answer a question, the system should not manufacture an answer. It should clearly state that the available customer-support knowledge base does not contain sufficient information.

Source citations should identify the document, page, relevance, and retrieved text needed to explain the answer. Internal prompts, credentials, environment variables, and unrelated system information should never be exposed through citations.

Support Interpretation Example 1

Example 1: A customer uses informal language to describe a company policy and customer service knowledge base issue. The correct response should map the customer's description to the closest documented policy or procedure, avoid unsupported assumptions, and identify the relevant next step. If the available documentation is insufficient, the response should stop at the knowledge-base limitation instead of supplying unrelated general knowledge.

Support Interpretation Example 2

Example 2: A customer uses informal language to describe a company policy and customer service knowledge base issue. The correct response should map the customer's description to the closest documented policy or procedure, avoid unsupported assumptions, and identify the relevant next step. If the available documentation is insufficient, the response should stop at the knowledge-base limitation instead of supplying unrelated general knowledge.

Support Interpretation Example 3

Example 3: A customer uses informal language to describe a company policy and customer service knowledge base issue. The correct response should map the customer's description to the closest documented policy or procedure, avoid unsupported assumptions, and identify the relevant next step. If the available documentation is insufficient, the response should stop at the knowledge-base limitation instead of supplying unrelated general knowledge.

Support Interpretation Example 4

Example 4: A customer uses informal language to describe a company policy and customer service knowledge base issue. The correct response should map the customer's description to the closest documented policy or procedure, avoid unsupported assumptions, and identify the relevant next step. If the available documentation is insufficient, the response should stop at the knowledge-base limitation instead of supplying unrelated general knowledge.

Support Interpretation Example 5

Example 5: A customer uses informal language to describe a company policy and customer service knowledge base issue. The correct response should map the customer's description to the closest documented policy or procedure, avoid unsupported assumptions, and identify the relevant next step. If the available documentation is insufficient, the response should stop at the knowledge-base limitation instead of supplying unrelated general knowledge.

Support Interpretation Example 6

Example 6: A customer uses informal language to describe a company policy and customer service knowledge base issue. The correct response should map the customer's description to the closest documented policy or procedure, avoid unsupported assumptions, and identify the relevant next step. If the available documentation is insufficient, the response should stop at the knowledge-base limitation instead of supplying unrelated general knowledge.